



City of Cambridge

POR 2026-143
FIRST IN COUNCIL
August 3, 2026

MAYOR SIDDIQUI
COUNCILLOR NOLAN
COUNCILLOR MCGOVERN
COUNCILLOR FLAHERTY

- WHEREAS: After [confusion](#) around a preliminary working draft of proposed changes to the Cambridge alcohol regulations, the City Council filed [POR 2026 #124](#), requesting a clear engagement process with stakeholders to help reduce barriers and ensure the City's licensing framework is as efficient and accessible as possible; and
- WHEREAS: During Council discussion, several recommendations were suggested including structural reforms to the Cambridge License Commission to modernize and improve its functions in supporting City staff; and
- WHEREAS: Several limitations exist in reforming the License Commission, which was established by state law, passed in the Special Acts of 1919, amended by Chapter 95 of the Acts of 1922, and further amended by Chapter 84 of the Acts of 1949, and modernizing the Cambridge License Commission will likely require a home rule petition; and
- WHEREAS: The structure of Cambridge's License Commission is unusual among Massachusetts municipalities and as it was established over a century ago, its composition should be reviewed to ensure alignment with modern standards and best practices; and
- WHEREAS: The City Council should consider opportunities to modernize the License Commission carefully and meet to discuss priorities, membership composition, and the impacts on the function of the License Commission; now therefore be it
- ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to work with relevant City departments to explore options for reforming and modernizing the License Commission, including through the home rule petition process; and be it further
- ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back to the Economic Development and University Relations Committee of the City Council in a timely manner.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Paula M. Crane".

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk



City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to work with relevant City departments to explore options for reforming and modernizing the License Commission, including through the home rule petition process.